

Word family: **stuffy / stuffier / stuffiest / stuffily / stuffiness**

Base word: **stuffy**

Comparative: **stuffier**

Superlative: **stuffiest**

Part of speech: **mainly adjective**

Related forms:

stuffyly (adv.) — 悶焗地；拘謹地

stuffiness (n.) — 悶焗；鼻塞；拘謹沉悶

Useful expressions / extensions:

stuffy room

stuffy office

stuffy air

feel stuffy

stuffy nose

stuffy atmosphere

stuffy person

stuffy attitude

stuffy rules

stuffy old-fashioned style

Meaning in this passage

> Being with him feels like opening a window and letting fresh air into a **stuffy room**.

Here, **stuffy** means:

uncomfortably warm, airless, and lacking fresh air — 悶焗的；空氣不流通的

中文翻譯：

和他相處，就像打開一扇窗，讓清新空氣進入一個**悶焗的房間**。

So here:

stuffy room = 空氣不流通、令人感到悶熱不舒服的房間

The sentence as a whole is metaphorical: adult life can feel stale and repetitive, while Leo brings freshness and energy.

1. **stuffy room/place** — 悶焗的；不通風的

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Being with him feels like opening a window and letting fresh air into a **stuffy room**.

和他相處，就像打開一扇窗，讓清新空氣進入一個**悶焗的房間**。

Practice 2

> The classroom was hot and **stuffy**.

課室又熱又**悶焗**。

Practice 3

> Let's open the windows; it's getting **stuffy** in here.

我們開窗吧，這裏開始變得很**焗促**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stuffy = 空氣不流通、令人覺得悶熱而不舒服的

2. **stuffy air** — 悶焗的空氣

Practice 1

> The room was full of **stuffy air**.

房間裏充滿了**悶焗的空氣**。

Practice 2

> I couldn't concentrate because the air felt **stuffy**.

因為空氣很**悶焗**，我無法集中精神。

MCQ-ready definition:

stuffy air = 不清新、不流通、令人感到焗促或不舒服的空氣

3. **feel stuffy** — 覺得悶焗 / 不透氣

Practice 1

> This room feels **stuffy**.

這個房間感覺很**悶焗**。

Practice 2

> It gets **stuffy** when too many people are inside.

裏面人太多時就會變得很**焗促**。

MCQ-ready definition:

feel/get stuffy = 空間因缺乏空氣流通而變得悶焗

4. **stuffy nose** — 鼻塞的

This is a very common bodily sense.

Practice 1

> I have a **stuffy nose**.

我**鼻塞**。

Practice 2

> A cold can make your nose feel **stuffy**.

感冒會令你的鼻子感到**塞住**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stuffy nose = 鼻腔堵塞、呼吸不暢的狀態

5. **stuffy** (鼻子 / 呼吸) — 堵塞的 ; 不暢通的

Practice 1

> My nose feels **stuffy** this morning.

我今早覺得**鼻塞**。

Practice 2

> She sounded **stuffy** because of her cold.

她因為感冒，說話聽起來有點**鼻塞**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stuffy = 因鼻腔堵塞而呼吸或說話不順暢的

6. **stuffy person** — 拘謹古板的；一本正經的

A major figurative sense.

Practice 1

> He can be a bit **stuffy** at formal events.

在正式場合，他有時會顯得有點**拘謹古板**。

Practice 2

> She is friendly, not **stuffy** at all.

她很友善，一點也不**古板拘謹**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stuffy = 人在態度或行為上過分正式、拘謹、缺乏輕鬆感

7. **stuffy attitude** — 古板拘謹的態度

Practice 1

> The organization needs to lose its **stuffy attitude**.

這個組織需要改掉那種**古板拘謹的態度**。

Practice 2

> His **stuffy attitude** made the meeting feel uncomfortable.

他那種**過分拘謹的態度**令會議氣氛很不自在。

MCQ-ready definition:

stuffy attitude = 過分正式、保守、缺乏彈性和輕鬆感的態度

8. **stuffy rules / traditions** — 古板保守的規則 / 傳統

Practice 1

> The club is known for its **stuffy rules**.

那個會所以**古板保守的規則**聞名。

Practice 2

> They wanted to modernize the school's **stuffy traditions**.

他們想把學校那些**陳舊拘謹的傳統**現代化。

MCQ-ready definition:

stuffy = 規則、制度或傳統過分正式保守、不夠靈活

9. **stuffy atmosphere** — 沉悶拘謹的氣氛

This can be physical or social, depending on context.

Practice 1

> The reception had a rather **stuffy atmosphere**.

那個接待會的氣氛相當**拘謹沉悶**。

Practice 2

> His jokes helped relax the **stuffy atmosphere**.

他的笑話令原本**拘謹的氣氛**放鬆下來。

MCQ-ready definition:

stuffy atmosphere = 過分正式、拘束、缺乏輕鬆感的社交氣氛

10. **stuffy style / writing** — 古板沉悶的風格 / 文風

Practice 1

> The report is accurate but a little **stuffy**.

這份報告雖然準確，但文風有點**古板沉悶**。

Practice 2

> The old textbook uses very **stuffy language**.

那本舊教科書使用非常**拘謹陳舊**的語言。

MCQ-ready definition:

stuffy = 風格、語言或表達過分正式、沉悶或老派

11. **stiffness (空氣悶焗)** — 悶焗；不通風

Practice 1

> The **stiffness** of the room made everyone sleepy.

房間的**悶焗感**令大家都昏昏欲睡。

Practice 2

> Opening the windows reduced the **stiffness**.

打開窗戶減輕了房間的**焗促感**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stiffness = 空氣不流通、令人感到悶焗的狀態

12. **stiffness (鼻塞)** — 鼻塞

Practice 1

> The medicine helped relieve nasal **stiffness**.

藥物幫助減輕了**鼻塞**。

Practice 2

> She complained of **stuffiness** and a sore throat.

她表示有**鼻塞**和喉嚨痛。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stuffiness = 鼻腔堵塞、不暢通的狀態****

13. **stuffiness (拘謹古板) — 拘謹 ; 古板**

Practice 1

> The new manager tried to reduce the **stuffiness** of the office culture.

新經理嘗試減少辦公室文化中的**拘謹古板感**。

Practice 2

> The event had none of the usual **stuffiness**.

這個活動完全沒有平常那種**拘束沉悶感**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stuffiness = 過分正式、古板、保守或缺乏輕鬆感的特質****

14. **stuffily — 拘謹地 ; 古板地**

Less common.

Practice 1

> He spoke rather **stuffily**.

他說話方式相當**拘謹古板**。

Practice 2

> The room was **stuffily decorated** in a formal old-fashioned style.

房間以一種**過分正式老派的風格**裝飾。

MCQ-ready definition:

stuffy = 以過分正式、古板或拘謹的方式

Important distinction 1: **stuffy** vs **hot**

hot

temperature is high.

stuffy

air is not circulating properly and feels unpleasant.

A room can be:

- * hot but well ventilated

- * cool but still stuffy

So **stuffy** ≠ simply **hot**.

Important distinction 2: **stuffy** vs **airless**

These overlap strongly.

airless

emphasizes lack of moving/fresh air.

stuffy

emphasizes the unpleasant feeling caused by that condition.

> an **airless room**

不通風的房間

> a **stuffy room**

令人悶焗不舒服的房間

Important distinction 3: **stuffy** vs **stale**

stale air

air that feels old, unpleasant, not fresh.

stuffy room

a room where air doesn't circulate well.

They often occur together:

> The room was **stuffy**, and the air smelled **stale**.

房間很悶焔，空氣也很不清新。

Important distinction 4: **stuffy** vs **humid**

humid

air contains a lot of moisture.

stuffy

air feels trapped and poorly ventilated.

A humid room can be stuffy, but the words describe different properties.

Important distinction 5: **stuffy** vs **cramped**

stuffy

about air/atmosphere.

cramped

about lack of physical space.

> a **stuffy office**

空氣不流通的辦公室

> a **cramped office**

空間狹窄的辦公室

Important distinction 6: **stuffy vs formal**

formal

neutral:

= follows accepted official/social conventions.

stuffy

negative:

= **too** formal, old-fashioned, or rigid.

So:

> a formal dinner

正式晚宴

does not necessarily mean:

> a stuffy dinner

拘謹沉悶的晚宴

Important distinction 7: **stuffy vs conservative**

conservative

prefers traditional ideas or gradual change.

stuffy

adds the feeling of being overly formal, rigid, dull, or old-fashioned.

A person can be conservative without being stuffy.

Important distinction 8: **stuffy vs boring**

boring

simply not interesting.

stuffy

can be boring because it is too formal, rigid, or old-fashioned.

So **stuffy** contains a more specific reason for the dullness.

Important distinction 9: **stuffy person vs shy person**

These are not the same.

shy

socially nervous or lacking confidence.

stuffy

overly formal, restrained, or old-fashioned.

A stuffy person may actually be very confident.

Important distinction 10: **stuffy nose vs blocked nose**

Very close.

stuffy nose

especially common in AmE.

blocked nose

especially common in BrE.

Both:

****鼻塞****

Important distinction 11: literal vs figurative ****stuffy****

Literal

> a ****stuffy room****

悶焗的房間

Figurative/social

> a ****stuffy meeting****

拘謹沉悶的會議

The metaphor is natural:

****physically hard to breathe / no fresh air****

→ ****socially hard to relax / no freshness or openness****

Family-extension note

****Stuffy**** has three clear modern branches:

1. ****physical environment****

- * stuffy room
- * stuffy air
- * poorly ventilated

2. ****physical condition****

- * stuffy nose
- * nasal stuffiness

3. ****social/personality/style****

- * stuffy person
- * stuffy atmosphere
- * stuffy rules

* stuffy writing

The figurative branch develops naturally from the physical one:

a room with no fresh air feels closed and uncomfortable

→ **a social environment with no openness feels rigid and uncomfortable**

So this is a good example of a word with a strong literal-to-figurative semantic extension.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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stuffy room	悶焗的房間	poor ventilation
stuffy air	悶焗空氣	stale/not circulating
feel stuffy	感到焗促	uncomfortable airflow
stuffy nose	鼻塞	blocked nasal passage
sound stuffy	聽起來鼻塞	nasal speech
stuffy person	古板拘謹的人	overly formal
stuffy attitude	古板拘謹的態度	rigid/old-fashioned
stuffy rules	古板規則	overly formal/rigid
stuffy atmosphere	拘謹沉悶的氣氛	socially restrictive
stuffy writing/style	古板沉悶的文風 / 風格	overly formal
stuffiness (room)	悶焗	poor ventilation
stuffiness (nose)	鼻塞	nasal blockage
stuffiness (social)	拘謹；古板	rigid formality
stuffily	拘謹地；古板地	overly formal manner

For your original sentence

> Being with him feels like opening a window and letting fresh air into a **stuffy room**.

Here:

stuffy = 悶焗的；空氣不流通的

The literal contrast is:

stuffy room

→ closed, stale, uncomfortable

versus:

****fresh air****

→ clean, moving, revitalizing

And metaphorically:

****adult life trapped in routine****

→ feels closed and stale

while:

****being with Leo****

→ introduces freshness, imagination, and energy

So ****stuffy room**** is a particularly effective metaphor here because ****stuffy**** can itself suggest both:

* physical lack of fresh air, and

* figurative dullness / rigidity.

That double association makes the sentence especially natural.